

ACME Corporation Employee Handbook

2024 Edition - Confidential

1. Remote Work Policy

ACME Corporation recognizes the importance of work-life balance and offers a flexible remote work arrangement for eligible employees. All full-time employees may work remotely up to **three (3) days per week** with prior approval from their direct manager. Remote work requests must be submitted through the HR portal at least 48 hours in advance. Employees working remotely must maintain the same level of productivity and availability as when working in the office. Core collaboration hours are from 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM EST, during which all employees must be reachable via company communication tools.

1.1 Equipment and Security

Employees working remotely must use company-provided equipment and connect through the corporate VPN. All confidential documents must be stored on approved cloud platforms only. Personal devices are not permitted for accessing sensitive company data without IT approval and encryption protocols.

1.2 Eligibility Criteria

To be eligible for remote work, employees must: (1) Have completed their probationary period of 90 days, (2) Maintain a performance rating of "Meets Expectations" or higher, (3) Have a suitable home workspace that meets ergonomic standards, and (4) Sign the Remote Work Agreement acknowledging responsibilities regarding data security and productivity.

2. Paid Time Off (PTO) Policy

ACME Corporation offers a generous PTO package to promote employee wellness and work-life balance. All full-time employees accrue **20 days (160 hours) of PTO per year**, which increases to 25 days after 5 years of service. Part-time employees accrue PTO on a prorated basis based on their scheduled hours. Unused PTO can be rolled over up to a maximum of 40 hours (5 days) into the next calendar year. Any excess PTO will be forfeited on December 31st unless approved for carryover by HR.

2.1 Requesting Time Off

All PTO requests must be submitted through the Workday HR system at least 5 business days in advance for vacations of 3 or more days. For single-day absences, 48 hours notice is required. Emergency PTO may be requested with manager approval. During peak business periods (Q4 for sales teams, product launches for engineering), PTO may be restricted and requires VP-level approval.

2.2 Holidays

ACME observes 10 paid holidays annually: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Jr. Day, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, Day after Thanksgiving, Christmas Eve, Christmas Day, and New Year's Eve. If a holiday falls on a weekend, the preceding Friday or following Monday is observed as the paid holiday.

3. Information Security Policy

Protecting company and customer data is a shared responsibility. All employees must complete annual security training and adhere to the following guidelines: (1) Use strong passwords with multi-factor authentication on all accounts, (2) Never share credentials or access tokens, (3) Report suspected security incidents to security@acme.com within 1 hour, (4) Encrypt all sensitive files before transmission, (5) Lock workstations when unattended, and (6) Follow the principle of least privilege when requesting system access.

3.1 Data Classification

Company data is classified into three levels: **Public** (no restrictions), **Internal** (share only within company), and **Confidential** (restricted to need-to-know basis). Customer data is always classified as Confidential. Breaches of Confidential data must be reported immediately to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

4. Performance Review Process

ACME conducts formal performance reviews twice annually: a mid-year check-in (June) and an annual review (December). The annual review determines salary adjustments, promotions, and bonus allocations. Employees are evaluated on four dimensions: (1) Goal Achievement (40%), (2) Core Competencies (30%), (3) Collaboration and Communication (20%), and (4) Innovation and Growth (10%). All employees must complete a self-assessment before their review meeting. Managers must provide written feedback at least 48 hours before the review discussion.

4.1 360-Degree Feedback

For senior roles (Manager and above), the annual review includes 360-degree feedback from peers, direct reports, and cross-functional partners. Feedback is collected anonymously through the Culture Amp platform. Minimum response rate of 60% is required for the feedback to be included in the review. Employees may nominate up to 8 reviewers for their 360 assessment.

5. Business Travel and Reimbursement

Employees traveling on company business are eligible for reimbursement of reasonable expenses. Pre-approval is required for all travel costing over \$500. Reimbursable expenses include: airfare (economy class for flights under 6 hours, business class for longer), hotel (up to \$200/night in major cities, \$150/night elsewhere), meals (up to \$75/day), ground transportation, and conference registration fees. All expenses must be submitted with receipts through Expensify within 30 days of the trip.

5.1 Per Diem Rates

For simplicity, employees may opt for a flat per diem instead of itemized receipts: \$60/day for meals in domestic locations, \$80/day for international travel. Per diem does not require receipts but cannot be combined with individual meal reimbursements. Alcohol is not reimbursable under any circumstances.

6. Code of Conduct

All ACME employees are expected to conduct themselves with integrity, respect, and professionalism. Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind is strictly prohibited. Employees must avoid conflicts of interest and disclose any personal relationships with vendors, clients, or competitors. Gifts from external parties exceeding \$50 in value must be reported to the Ethics Committee. Violations of the Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action, including termination and legal proceedings where applicable.

6.1 Reporting Concerns

Employees can report concerns through multiple channels: direct manager, HR department, anonymous ethics hotline (1-800-ETHICS), or the online reporting portal. ACME maintains a strict no-retaliation policy for good-faith reports. All reports are investigated within 10 business days, and the reporter receives a status update within 30 days.

7. IT Support and Contact Information

The IT Support team is available to assist with hardware, software, and network issues. Support hours are Monday through Friday, 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM EST. For urgent issues outside these hours, contact the on-call engineer at +1-555-IT-HELP. The IT Service Desk can be reached via: Email: itsupport@acme.com, Phone: x5500 (internal) or +1-555-555-5500 (external), Slack: #it-help channel, or the ServiceNow portal for ticket tracking.

7.1 Common Issues

For password resets, use the self-service portal at password.acme.com. For VPN issues, ensure you have the latest Cisco AnyConnect client installed. For software requests, submit a ticket through ServiceNow with business justification. Standard software (Office 365, Slack, Zoom) is approved automatically. Development tools and specialized software require manager approval.

8. New Employee Onboarding

All new hires participate in a structured 2-week onboarding program. Week 1 focuses on orientation: company culture, policies, systems access, and compliance training. Week 2 focuses on role-specific training with the hiring manager and buddy assignment. New hires must complete all compliance modules (security, harassment prevention, data privacy) within the first 5 days. IT equipment is shipped 3 days before the start date. On the first day, new hires meet with HR for I-9 verification and benefits enrollment.

8.1 30-60-90 Day Plan

Each new hire receives a customized 30-60-90 day plan: **Days 1-30:** Learn systems, meet stakeholders, complete training. **Days 31-60:** Take ownership of first project, contribute to team meetings. **Days 61-90:** Deliver first significant output, receive initial feedback, set long-term goals. A formal check-in is scheduled at each milestone with the manager and HR business partner.